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Philosophy Honors (#2120910)

Version: 2026 - And Beyond

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Course Version Note

Updated course description.

Course Standards

Visit the specific benchmark webpage to find related instructional resources.

- [SS.912.A.1.4:](#) Analyze how images, symbols, objects, cartoons, graphs, charts, maps, and artwork may be used to interpret the significance of time periods and events from the past.
- [SS.912.A.1.5:](#)
Evaluate the validity, reliability, bias, and authenticity of current events, and Internet resources.
- [SS.912.A.1.7:](#) Describe various socio-cultural aspects of American life including arts, artifacts, literature, education, and publications.
- [SS.912.A.3.10:](#) Review different economic and philosophic ideologies.
- [SS.912.G.2.1:](#) Identify the physical characteristics and the human characteristics that define and differentiate regions.
- [SS.912.G.2.2:](#) Describe the factors and processes that contribute to the differences between developing and developed regions of the world.

- [SS.912.G.2.3](#): Use geographic terms and tools to analyze case studies of regional issues in different parts of the world that have critical economic, physical, or political ramifications.
- [SS.912.H.1.4](#): Explain philosophical beliefs as they relate to works in the arts.
- [SS.912.H.2.3](#): Apply various types of critical analysis (contextual, formal, and intuitive criticism) to works in the arts, including the types and use of symbolism within art forms and their philosophical implications.
- [SS.912.H.3.1](#): Analyze the effects of transportation, trade, communication, science, and technology on the preservation and diffusion of culture.
- [SS.912.H.3.2](#): Identify social, moral, ethical, religious, and legal issues arising from technological and scientific developments, and examine their influence on works of arts within a culture.
- [SS.912.HC.1.1](#): Describe the intellectual origins and nature of utopian thought.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes Plato's Republic and Thomas More's Utopia.

Clarification 2: : Instruction includes different definitions of utopia (e.g., equality of wealth, sufficiency of wealth, equality of leisure, equality of happiness).

Clarification 3: Instruction includes the enduring barriers to achieving a utopia (e.g., self-interest, competition, scarcity of resources, overregulation, corruption).

Clarification 4: Instruction includes the dangers of striving to create a utopia by force (e.g., violence, coercion, collectivization, dehumanization).

- [SS.912.HC.1.2](#): Examine how the Enlightenment contributed to the development of communism.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes Jean Jacques Rousseau's *Discourse on Inequality* and James Madison's subsequent critique in *Federalist #10*.

- [SS.912.HC.1.8](#): Describe various contemporary responses to the theories of Karl Marx and Friedrich Engels.

Clarifications:

Clarification 1: Instruction includes conservative responses (e.g., Imperial Germany's State Socialism).

Clarification 2: Instruction includes liberal responses (e.g., the United Kingdom's New Liberalism).

Clarification 3: Instruction includes religious responses (e.g., Pope Leo XIII's *Rerum Novarum* (1891), the Netherlands' Anti-Revolutionary Party).

Clarification 4: Instruction includes socialist responses (e.g., the United Kingdom's Fabian Society, George Bernard Shaw).

- [SS.912.S.1.4:](#) Examine changing points of view of social issues such as poverty, crime, and discrimination.
- [SS.912.W.1.1:](#) Use timelines to establish cause and effect relationships of historical events.
- [SS.912.W.1.3:](#) Interpret and evaluate primary and secondary sources.
- [SS.912.W.1.4:](#) Explain how historians use historical inquiry and other sciences to understand the past.
- [SS.912.W.1.5:](#) Compare conflicting interpretations or schools of thought about world events and individual contributions to history (historiography).
- [SS.912.W.1.6:](#) Evaluate the role of history in shaping identity and character.
- [SS.912.W.2.5:](#) Explain the contributions of the Byzantine Empire.
- [SS.912.W.2.12:](#) Recognize the importance of Christian monasteries and convents as centers of education, charitable and missionary activity, economic productivity, and political power.
- [SS.912.W.2.13:](#) Explain how Western civilization arose from a synthesis of classical Greco-Roman civilization, Judeo-Christian influence, and the cultures of northern European peoples promoting a cultural unity in Europe.
- [SS.912.W.2.17:](#) Identify key figures, artistic, and intellectual achievements of the medieval period in Western Europe.
- [SS.912.W.2.20:](#) Summarize the major cultural, economic, political, and religious developments in medieval Japan.
- [SS.912.W.2.22:](#) Describe Japan's cultural and economic relationship to China and Korea.

- SS.912.W.3.1: Discuss significant people and beliefs associated with Islam.
- SS.912.W.3.2: Compare the major beliefs and principles of Judaism, Christianity, and Islam.
- SS.912.W.3.4: Describe the expansion of Islam into India and the relationship between Muslims and Hindus.
- SS.912.W.5.2: Identify major causes of the Enlightenment.
- SS.912.W.5.3: Summarize the major ideas of Enlightenment philosophers.
- SS.912.W.5.4: Evaluate the impact of Enlightenment ideals on the development of economic, political, and religious structures in the Western world.
- SS.912.W.5.5: Analyze the extent to which the Enlightenment impacted the American and French Revolutions.
- SS.912.W.6.3: Compare the philosophies of capitalism, socialism and communism as described by Adam Smith, Robert Owen, and Karl Marx.
- SS.912.W.6.4: Describe the 19th and early 20th century social and political reforms and reform movements and their effects in Africa, Asia, Europe, the United States, the Caribbean and Latin America.
- MA.K12.MTR.1.1: **Actively participate in effortful learning both individually and collectively.**

Mathematicians who participate in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Analyze the problem in a way that makes sense given the task.
- Ask questions that will help with solving the task.
- Build perseverance by modifying methods as needed while solving a challenging task.
- Stay engaged and maintain a positive mindset when working to solve tasks.
- Help and support each other when attempting a new method or approach.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to participate actively in effortful learning both individually and with others:

- Cultivate a community of growth mindset learners.
- Foster perseverance in students by choosing tasks that are challenging.
- Develop students' ability to analyze and problem solve.
- Recognize students' effort when solving challenging problems.

- **MA.K12.MTR.2.1: Demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways.**

Mathematicians who demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways:

- Build understanding through modeling and using manipulatives.
- Represent solutions to problems in multiple ways using objects, drawings, tables, graphs and equations.
- Progress from modeling problems with objects and drawings to using algorithms and equations.
- Express connections between concepts and representations.
- Choose a representation based on the given context or purpose.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to demonstrate understanding by representing problems in multiple ways:

- Help students make connections between concepts and representations.
- Provide opportunities for students to use manipulatives when investigating concepts.
- Guide students from concrete to pictorial to abstract representations as understanding progresses.
- Show students that various representations can have different purposes and can be useful in different situations.

- **MA.K12.MTR.3.1: Complete tasks with mathematical fluency.**

Mathematicians who complete tasks with mathematical fluency:

- Select efficient and appropriate methods for solving problems within the given context.

- Maintain flexibility and accuracy while performing procedures and mental calculations.
- Complete tasks accurately and with confidence.
- Adapt procedures to apply them to a new context.
- Use feedback to improve efficiency when performing calculations.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to complete tasks with mathematical fluency:

- Provide students with the flexibility to solve problems by selecting a procedure that allows them to solve efficiently and accurately.
- Offer multiple opportunities for students to practice efficient and generalizable methods.
- Provide opportunities for students to reflect on the method they used and determine if a more efficient method could have been used.

• **MA.K12.MTR.4.1: Engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others.**

Mathematicians who engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others:

- Communicate mathematical ideas, vocabulary and methods effectively.
- Analyze the mathematical thinking of others.
- Compare the efficiency of a method to those expressed by others.
- Recognize errors and suggest how to correctly solve the task.
- Justify results by explaining methods and processes.
- Construct possible arguments based on evidence.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to engage in discussions that reflect on the mathematical thinking of self and others:

- Establish a culture in which students ask questions of the teacher and their peers, and error is an opportunity for learning.
- Create opportunities for students to discuss their thinking with peers.

- Select, sequence and present student work to advance and deepen understanding of correct and increasingly efficient methods.
- Develop students' ability to justify methods and compare their responses to the responses of their peers.
- **MA.K12.MTR.5.1: Use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts.**

Mathematicians who use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts:

- Focus on relevant details within a problem.
- Create plans and procedures to logically order events, steps or ideas to solve problems.
- Decompose a complex problem into manageable parts.
- Relate previously learned concepts to new concepts.
- Look for similarities among problems.
- Connect solutions of problems to more complicated large-scale situations.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to use patterns and structure to help understand and connect mathematical concepts:

- Help students recognize the patterns in the world around them and connect these patterns to mathematical concepts.
- Support students to develop generalizations based on the similarities found among problems.
- Provide opportunities for students to create plans and procedures to solve problems.
- Develop students' ability to construct relationships between their current understanding and more sophisticated ways of thinking.

- **MA.K12.MTR.6.1: Assess the reasonableness of solutions.**

Mathematicians who assess the reasonableness of solutions:

- Estimate to discover possible solutions.
- Use benchmark quantities to determine if a solution makes sense.
- Check calculations when solving problems.
- Verify possible solutions by explaining the methods used.

- Evaluate results based on the given context.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to assess the reasonableness of solutions:

- Have students estimate or predict solutions prior to solving.
- Prompt students to continually ask, “Does this solution make sense? How do you know?”
- Reinforce that students check their work as they progress within and after a task.
- Strengthen students’ ability to verify solutions through justifications.

• **MA.K12.MTR.7.1: Apply mathematics to real-world contexts.**

Mathematicians who apply mathematics to real-world contexts:

- Connect mathematical concepts to everyday experiences.
- Use models and methods to understand, represent and solve problems.
- Perform investigations to gather data or determine if a method is appropriate.
- Redesign models and methods to improve accuracy or efficiency.

Clarifications:

Teachers who encourage students to apply mathematics to real-world contexts:

- Provide opportunities for students to create models, both concrete and abstract, and perform investigations.
- Challenge students to question the accuracy of their models and methods.
- Support students as they validate conclusions by comparing them to the given situation.
- Indicate how various concepts can be applied to other disciplines.

• **ELA.K12.EE.1.1: Cite evidence to explain and justify reasoning.**

Clarifications:

K-1 Students include textual evidence in their oral communication with guidance and support from adults. The evidence can consist of details from the text without naming the text. During 1st grade, students learn how to incorporate the evidence in their writing.

2-3 Students include relevant textual evidence in their written and oral communication. Students should name the text when they refer to it. In 3rd grade, students should use a combination of direct and indirect citations.

4-5 Students continue with previous skills and reference comments made by speakers and peers. Students cite texts that they've directly quoted, paraphrased, or used for information. When writing, students will use the form of citation dictated by the instructor or the style guide referenced by the instructor.

6-8 Students continue with previous skills and use a style guide to create a proper citation.

9-12 Students continue with previous skills and should be aware of existing style guides and the ways in which they differ.

- [ELA.K12.EE.2.1](#): Read and comprehend grade-level complex texts proficiently.

Clarifications:

See [Text Complexity](#) for grade-level complexity bands and a text complexity rubric.

- [ELA.K12.EE.3.1](#): Make inferences to support comprehension.

Clarifications:

Students will make inferences before the words infer or inference are introduced. Kindergarten students will answer questions like "Why is the girl smiling?" or make predictions about what will happen based on the title page. Students will use the terms and apply them in 2nd grade and beyond.

- [ELA.K12.EE.4.1](#): Use appropriate collaborative techniques and active listening skills when engaging in discussions in a variety of situations.

Clarifications:

In kindergarten, students learn to listen to one another respectfully.

In grades 1-2, students build upon these skills by justifying what they are thinking. For example: "I think _____ because _____." The collaborative conversations are becoming academic conversations.

In grades 3-12, students engage in academic conversations discussing claims and justifying their reasoning, refining and

applying skills. Students build on ideas, propel the conversation, and support claims and counterclaims with evidence.

- [ELA.K12.EE.5.1](#): Use the accepted rules governing a specific format to create quality work.

Clarifications:

Students will incorporate skills learned into work products to produce quality work. For students to incorporate these skills appropriately, they must receive instruction. A 3rd grade student creating a poster board display must have instruction in how to effectively present information to do quality work.

- [ELA.K12.EE.6.1](#): Use appropriate voice and tone when speaking or writing.

Clarifications:

In kindergarten and 1st grade, students learn the difference between formal and informal language. For example, the way we talk to our friends differs from the way we speak to adults. In 2nd grade and beyond, students practice appropriate social and academic language to discuss texts.

- [ELD.K12.ELL.SI.1](#): English language learners communicate for social and instructional purposes within the school setting.
- [ELD.K12.ELL.SS.1](#): English language learners communicate information, ideas and concepts necessary for academic success in the content area of Social Studies.

Course Information

General Notes

Required Instruction:

[Section 1003.42, Florida Statutes](#), outlines the topics that must be taught in Florida's public schools as part of required instruction. The Florida Department of Education supports districts in fulfilling these requirements through guidance, resources and tools to ensure students receive instruction that promotes civic responsibility, character development, historical understanding and digital safety.

The primary content emphasis for this course pertains to the study of the fundamental questions pertinent to all areas of human activity and inquiries.

Content should include, but is not limited to:

- Introduction to classical and modern philosophies
- The fundamental principles of philosophical thought
 - Semantics
 - Logic
 - Inductive and deductive reasoning
- Social, political and religious philosophies

Honors and Advanced Level Course Note: Advanced courses require a greater demand on students through increased academic rigor. Academic rigor is obtained through the application, analysis, evaluation and creation of complex ideas that are often abstract and multi-faceted. Students are challenged to think and collaborate critically on the content they are learning. Honors level rigor will be achieved by increasing text complexity through text selection, focus on high-level qualitative measures and complexity of tasks. Instruction will be structured to give students a deeper understanding of conceptual themes and organization within and across disciplines. Academic rigor is more than simply assigning students a greater quantity of work.

Mathematics Thinking and Reasoning Standards (MTRs)

The MTR are built on the following premises:

- Florida's state academic standards for social studies are taught through the lens of the MTRs; the MTRs are embedded throughout every lesson;
- language of the MTRs are expectations for students to use as self-monitoring tools during instruction every day;
- ensures that students are engaged, persevere in tasks, share their thinking, balance conceptual understanding and procedures, assess their solutions and make connections to previous and extended knowledge/learning; and
- standards should not stand alone as a separate focus for instruction, but should be combined purposefully.

English Language Arts (ELA) Expectations (EEs)

- The ELA Expectations are those overarching skills that run through every component of instruction.

- These are skills that students should be using throughout the instruction of Florida's state academic standards for social studies.

For guidance on the implementation of the Ees, please visit [ELA B.E.S.T. STANDARDS: ENGLISH LANGUAGE ARTS](#). To access Mathematics Resources please visit [B.E.S.T Mathematics Resources \(fldoe.org\)](#).

English Language Development (ELDs)

- The ELDs are adopted from the World-Class Instruction Design and Assessment Consortium or WIDA.
- The standards represent the social, instructional and academic language that students need to engage with peers, educators and the curriculum in schools.

Teachers are required to provide listening, speaking, reading and writing instruction that allows English Language Learners (ELL) to communicate for social and instructional purposes within the school setting. For the given level of English language proficiency and with visual, graphic, or interactive support, students will interact with grade level words, expressions, sentences and discourse to process or produce language necessary for academic success. The ELD standard should specify a relevant content area concept or topic of study chosen by curriculum developers and teachers which maximizes an ELL's need for communication and social skills. To access an ELL supporting document which delineates performance definitions and descriptors, please click on the following link: <https://cpalmsmediaprod.blob.core.windows.net/uploads/docs/standards/eld/si.pdf>

General Information

Course Number: 2120910

Course Path: **Section:** Grades PreK to 12 Education Courses >

Grade Group: Grades 9 to 12 and Adult Education Courses >

Subject: Social Studies > **SubSubject:** Philosophy and Religion >

Abbreviated Title: PHILOS HON

Number of Credits: Half credit (.5)

Course Length: Semester (S)

Course Attributes:

- Honors

Course Type: Elective Course
Course Level: 3
Course Status: Course Approved
Grade Level(s): 9,10,11,12

Educator Certifications

One of these educator certification options is required to teach this course.

- [History \(Grades 6-12\)](#)
- [Social Science \(Grades 6-12\)](#)
- [Humanities \(Elementary and Secondary Grades K-12\)](#)
- [Classical Education - Restricted \(Elementary and Secondary Grades K-12\)](#)

Section 1012.55(5), F.S., authorizes the issuance of a classical education teaching certificate, upon the request of a classical school, to any applicant who fulfills the requirements of s. 1012.56(2)(a)-(f) and (11), F.S., and Rule 6A-4.004, F.A.C. Classical schools must meet the requirements outlined in s. 1012.55(5), F.S., and be listed in the [FLDOE Master School ID](#) database, to request a restricted classical education teaching certificate on behalf of an applicant.